

ENG507

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Recent Papers

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Write three sentences with stressed words and underline the stressed words

Here are three sentences with stressed words underlined:

1. I **LOVE** chocolate cake.
2. She **WENT** to the store yesterday.
3. We **NEED** to talk about the meeting.

In each sentence, the underlined word is the one that carries the primary stress, meaning it's emphasized more than the other words around it.

Essential requirements of human speech production. any 3

There are three possible mechanisms involved in human speech production.

- 1) The most common one is the moving of air by compression of the lungs so that the air is expelled through the vocal tract this is called a pulmonic airstream.
- 2) The second one is the glottalic (produced by the larynx with closed vocal folds - it is moved up and down like the plunger of a bicycle pump).
- 3) last one is called velaric (where the back of the tongue is pressed against the soft palate or velum)

Airstream mechanism names

- ❖ Pulmonic Airstream Mechanism
- ❖ Glottalic Airstream Mechanism
- ❖ Velaric Airstream Mechanism

Define Rhotic accent

In rhotic (e.g., some American) accents, on the other hand, /r/ may occur before consonants (as in 'cart' /ka:rt/) and before a pause (as in 'car' /kɑ:r/).

most speakers of American English speak with a rhotic accent, but there are non-rhotic areas including the Boston area, lower-class New York and the Deep South.

Other names of narrow and broad transcription

Narrow and broad transcription in phonetics can also be referred to by the following alternative terms:

Narrow Transcription:

- ❖ Phonetic Transcription
- ❖ Impressionistic transcription

Broad Transcription:

- ❖ Phonemic Transcription

Rules for English Consonant Allophones (ECA):

Based on the above discussion on overlapping and co-articulatory gestures, the rules for English consonantal allophones are summarized here in this topic. Remember that it is just a list of a set of formal statements simply describing the behavior of a language. These are not the kind of prescriptive grammar rules that people are expected to abide by.

- 1)** Consonants **are longer** when at the end of a phrase (e.g., bib, did, don and nod).
- 2)** Voiceless stops (e.g., p, t, k) **are aspirated** when they are syllable initial (pip, test, kick).
- 3)** Voiced obstruents (b, d, g, v, ð, z, ʒ) **are voiced** only when they occur at the end of an utterance or before a voiceless sound.
- 4)** 4. Voiced stops (b, d, g) and affricate (dʒ) **are voiceless** when they are syllable initial (except when immediately preceded by a voiced sound – compare a day with this day).

- 5) Voiceless stops (p, t, k) are **unaspirated** after /s/ in words such as spew, stew and skew.
- 6) Voiceless obstruent's (p, t, k, tʃ, f, θ, s, ʃ) **are longer** than their voiced counterparts (b, d, g, dʒ, v, ð, z, ʒ) at the end of a syllable (e.g., cap - cab and back – bag).
- 7) Approximants (w, r, j, l) are at least partially voiceless when they occur after initial voiceless stop sounds (e.g., play, twin, cue).
- 8) The gestures for consecutive stops overlap, so that stops are unexploded when they occur before another stop (e.g., apt and rubbed).
- 9) In many accents of English, syllable final voiceless stops /p, t, k/ are accompanied by an overlapping glottal stop gesture (e.g., tip, pit, kick).
- 10) /t/ is replaced by a glottal stop when it occurs before an alveolar nasal (e.g., beaten).
- 11) Nasals are syllabic at the end of a word - after an obstruent (e.g., leaden, chasm).
- 12) The lateral // is syllabic at the end of a word - a consonant (e.g., paddle, whistle).

What is true and what is false about American vowels:

- a) Californians do not distinguish between "father " and " author" vowel **(TRUE)**
- b) The vowels [ʊ, u] as in good and food also vary considerably **(TRUE)**

What are the methods for analyzing intonation:

There are several ways for analyzing intonation. In some approaches, the pitch patterns are described as contours and are further analyzed in terms of levels of pitch as pitch phonemes and morphemes. In others, the patterns are described as tone units or tone groups, analyzed further as contrasts of nuclear tone, tonicity, etc. The three variables (1) pitch range; (2) height and (3) direction are generally distinguished. Some approaches (especially within pragmatics), operate with a much broader notion than that of the tone unit (i.e., intonational phrasing is a structured hierarchy of the intonational constituents in conversation). A formal category of intonational phrase is also sometimes recognized (i.e., an utterance span dominated by boundary tones). One of the most recently developed methods is called the 'tone and break indices' (ToBI). This method is used for the description of intonation (H/L) representing pitch changes and showing pitch accent

– phrase accent and boundary by showing tone and break indices. This is based on describing High (H) and Low (L) pitches in a sentence representing pitch changes and showing pitch accent – phrase accent and boundary (of the phrase).

Which articulators are used in following process

1: Labial

2: Coronal

3: Dorsal

Here are the articulators used for each process:

1. Labial: Lips
2. Coronal: Tongue tip or blade
3. Dorsal: Tongue back or body

DEFINE THE NUMBER OF SYLLABLE IN THE FOLLOWING WORDS.

- A) EXIST
- B) PRONUNCIATION
- C) ENOUGH

Here are the syllable counts for each word:

- A) EXIST - 2 syllables (ex-ist)
- B) PRONUNCIATION - 5 syllables (pro-nun-ci-a-tion)
- C) ENOUGH - 2 syllables (en-ough)

What are the three criteria for consonant sounds and how many consonants are in English?

There are **24 consonants** in the RP accent of English.

These consonants are described in terms of:

- ❖ Voicing
- ❖ Manners of articulation
- ❖ Place of articulation.

IDENTIFY THREE SUPRASEGMENTAL FEATURES OF SOUNDS.

VOWELS

PITCH

CONSONANTS

PHONEMES

INTONATION

DURATION

1. Pitch
2. Intonation
3. Duration

Examples of phonemes

Vowel Phonemes:

1. /i/ → *beat* vs. *bit*

Consonant Phonemes:

1. /p/ → *pin* vs. *bin*
2. /b/ → *bat* vs. *pat*

Write the categories of English fricatives

Very common fricative sounds are /f, v, s, z, θ, ð, h/ whereas [ʒ] is a less common fricative sound. English fricatives are also divided into **two categories** (this distinction is made on the basis of energy made in their production); **fortis:** /f, s, θ, ʃ, h/ and **lenis:** /v,

z, ð, ʒ/. Stops and fricatives are together called 'obstruent's and they are similar in three ways:

- (1) They influence vowel length (vowels are shorter before voiceless obstruents),
- (2) Voiceless obstruent's at final position are longer than their voiced counterparts (e.g., race vs. rays), and
- (3) Obstruent's are voiced only if the adjacent segments are also voiced (e.g., dogs).

What is pitch variation?

Pitch variation refers to the changes in the frequency of the voice during speech, which affects how high or low a sound is perceived. These changes occur naturally in spoken language and are critical for conveying meaning, emotion, and emphasis.

Types of Pitch Variation

- ❖ Rising Pitch
- ❖ *Falling Pitch*
- ❖ *Level Pitch*
- ❖ *Contour Pitch*

English sounds are briefly introduced here:

- Plosives 6
- Nasals 3
- Fricatives 9
- Affricates 2
- Approximants 4

Write a note on Acoustic phonetic.

Acoustic phonetics is related to the study of physical attributes of sounds produced by the vocal tract. It is the branch of phonetics which studies the **physical properties** of speech sound as transmitted between mouth and ear according to the principles of acoustics (the branch of physics devoted to the study of sound). It is primarily dependent on the use of

instrumental techniques of investigation (such as Praat software), particularly electronics, and some grounding in physics and mathematics is a prerequisite for advanced study of this subject. Its importance to the phonetician is that acoustic analysis can provide a clear, objective datum for the investigation of speech – the physical ‘facts’ of speech sounds (such as duration, formants F1, F2 and F3, etc.). Thus, acoustic evidence is often referred to when one wants to support an analysis being made in articulatory or auditory phonetic terms. On the other hand, it is important not to become too reliant on acoustic analyses, which are subject to mechanical limitations (e.g. the need to calibrate measuring devices accurately), and which are often themselves open to multiple interpretations.

Write the names of human speech sounds.

Human speech sounds are the audible vibrations produced by the human vocal apparatus during speech. These sounds are the building blocks of spoken language and allow us to communicate meaning through spoken words.

Human speech sounds are broadly categorized into **vowels** and **consonants**

Enlist the issue of English vowel sound?? any five

1) **Spelling vs. Sound**

- English vowels are not pronounced the way they are spelled.
- Example: "a" sounds different in *cat* and *cake*.

2) **Similar Vowel Sounds**

- Some vowels sound very close and are hard to tell apart.
- Example: *bit* (/ɪ/) vs. *beat* (/i:/).

3) **Long and Short Vowels**

- Learners confuse long and short vowel sounds.
- Example: *ship* (/ɪ/) vs. *sheep* (/i:/).

4) **The Schwa Sound (/ə/)**

- The most common English vowel sound is hard to notice because it's unstressed.
- Example: *sofa* → /'sʊfə/.

5) **Unstressed Vowels Change**

- Vowels in unstressed parts of words often change to a schwa.
- Example: *present* → /'prezənt/ vs. /prɪ'zent/.

6) Different Accents

- Vowel sounds change depending on accents.
- Example: *bath* is /bæθ/ in the US but /bɑːθ/ in the UK.

7) Diphthongs

- Some vowels glide between two sounds, which can be tricky.
- Example: /aɪ/ in *time* or /oʊ/ in *go*.

What is Intonation?

Intonation is the rise and fall of the voice when we speak. It helps to show meaning, emotions, or whether we're asking a question, making a statement, or expressing surprise.

Examples:

Rising Intonation:

- Used for yes/no questions.
- Example: "*Are you coming?*" (Voice goes up at the end.)

Why is Intonation Important?

- It changes the meaning of sentences.
- It makes speech sound natural and clear.
- It shows feelings like anger, happiness, or doubt.

How many long and short vowels?

There are **44 sounds** in English RP (BBC) accent. Out of them, **20 are vowels** which, in turn, are further divided into pure vowels and diphthongs. Pure vowels or **monophthongs are 12** out of which **5 are long and 7 are short vowels**.

Stress-timed rhythm hypothesis?

Stress-timed rhythm is a pattern in speech where the timing between stressed syllables stays roughly equal, no matter how many unstressed syllables come in between.

Example:

In the sentence:

"I can see the big house."

- **Stressed syllables:** *can, see, big, house*
- These stressed syllables occur at roughly equal time intervals.
- **Unstressed syllables:** *I, the*
- The unstressed syllables are much shorter and said more quickly than the stressed ones.

Languages like English **and German are stress-timed**; while languages like Spanish and Japanese have a syllable-timed rhythm (every syllable takes about the same amount of time).

Syllable-timed languages?

Languages where the length of each syllable remains more or less the same as that of its neighbors whether or not it is stressed are called syllable-timed languages.

❖ French

- In French, syllables are pronounced with more equal timing.
- Example: In the phrase "*Je suis allé à Paris*" (I went to Paris), each syllable (Je, suis, al, lé, à, Pa, ris) gets roughly the same amount of time.

❖ Spanish

- Spanish also follows a syllable-timed rhythm, where syllables tend to be spaced evenly.
- Example: In "*Me gusta bailar*" (I like to dance), the syllables (Me, gus, ta, bai, lar) have equal stress.

❖ Greek

- Greek is also considered syllable-timed, with syllables having an equal duration in speech.
- Example: In "*Καλημέρα*" (Good morning), each syllable (Ka, li, mè, ra) has equal length.

Syllable-Timed vs. Stress-Timed Languages:

- **Stress-timed languages** (like English) focus on stressed syllables with gaps between them, making speech sound more uneven.
- **Syllable-timed languages** (like French or Spanish) distribute the time equally across all syllables, creating a smoother and more even rhythm.

What is segmental feature of sound?

Segmental features of sound refer to the characteristics of individual speech sounds, such as vowels and consonants. These features describe the physical properties of speech sounds, including:

- ❖ Place of articulation (where the sound is made in the mouth)
- ❖ Manner of articulation (how the sound is made)
- ❖ Voicing (whether the sound is made with the vocal cords vibrating)
- ❖ Phonemes (distinct units of sound that distinguish one word from another)

Segmental features are used to describe and analyze the individual sounds of language, and are a key part of phonetics and phonology.

Separate the three segmental feature of sound.

1. Vowels

2. Pitch

3. Duration

4. Constant

5. Phonemes

6. Initiation

The **three segmental features** of speech sounds are generally **vowels, consonants,** and **phonemes**.

How Phonetician transcribing connected speech. Enlist five of them

- 1) **Assimilation:** Changes in sounds to become more like neighboring sounds.
- 2) **Rhythm:** The pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables.
- 3) **Stress:** Emphasis on certain syllables or words.

- 4) **Elision**: Omission of sounds to simplify speech.
- 5) **Linking**: Connecting sounds between words.
- 6) **Tone**: The use of pitch to convey meaning in tone languages.
- 7) **Intonation**: The rise and fall of pitch to convey meaning or emotion.

What are the possible types of articulatory gestures?

- ❖ **Bilabial gesture** – very common in English (e.g., stops and nasal: p, b, m), In some languages (such as Ewe of West Africa), bilabial fricatives contrast with labiodental fricatives. The symbols for the voiceless and voiced bilabial fricatives are [ɸβ]. These sounds are pronounced by bringing the two lips nearly together, so that there is only a slit between them. Ewe also contrasts voiceless bilabial and labiodental fricatives.
- ❖ **Labiodentals fricatives** – many languages (including English) have the labiodental fricatives [f, v]. But probably no language has labiodental stops or nasals except as allophones of the corresponding bilabial sounds. In English, a labiodental nasal, [m̪], may occur when /m/ occurs before /f/, as in emphasis or symphony.

From the list which of the following are not aspects of connected speech

(Assimilation, Elision, co-articulation, overlapping, collision)

From the list, the following are **not** aspects of connected speech:

- 1.** Co-articulation
- 2.** Collision

Short vowel. example of short vowels in words. And underline the vowels in word.

Short vowels are vowel sounds that are pronounced quickly and without the long vowel sound (like the name of the letter). Here are examples of words with short vowels, with the vowels underlined:

1. **Short "a"**: cat, bat, mat
2. **Short "e"**: bet, pet, leg
3. **Short "i"**: bit, sit, pin
4. **Short "o"**: hot, pot, dog

5. Short "u": cup, bug, run

In each case, the vowel is pronounced as a short sound, distinct from its "long" counterpart.

Peter - Ladefoged present three experimental phonetic?

Peter Ladefoged explored the following three areas of experimental phonetics in 1967:

- Stress in respiratory activity
- The nature of vowel quality
- Perception and production of speech

Explain Intonation features.

Intonation refers to the variation in pitch when we speak. It conveys meaning, emotion, or emphasis in spoken language. Here are the main features of intonation:

1. Pitch

- The rise and fall of voice tone.
- Higher or lower pitch can signal different meanings or emotions.
- Example: A rising pitch often indicates a question, while a falling pitch might signal a statement or conclusion.

2. Stress

- The emphasis placed on specific words or syllables.
- Stressed words or syllables are often spoke louder, longer, and with a slightly higher pitch.
- Example: "I *didn't* say he stole it" vs. "I didn't *say* he stole it."

3. Tone

- The quality or attitude conveyed in speech (e.g., neutral, questioning, sarcastic).
- Tone helps to show emotion or intent, even with the same words.

4. Rhythm

- The pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables.
- Intonation often follows the natural rhythm of a language, such as stress-timed or syllable-timed patterns.

5. Contour (Melody)

- The shape of the pitch movement (rising, falling, or a combination):
 - **Falling intonation:** Signals finality or certainty (e.g., "I am here.").
 - **Rising intonation:** Signals questions or uncertainty (e.g., "Are you here?").
 - **Rising-falling intonation:** Signals surprise or emphasis (e.g., "Really?!").
 - **Level intonation:** Can indicate boredom or lack of interest.

Importance of Intonation

- **Emotion:** Shows feelings like excitement, anger, or sarcasm.
- **Grammar:** Differentiates between statements, questions, and exclamations.
- **Focus:** Highlights important parts of a sentence.

Understanding intonation is crucial for effective communication, especially in languages like English, where it plays a significant role in conveying meaning.

IMP MCQs

‘Linguistics’ is the study of language; how it is put together and how it functions. In other words, various building blocks of different types and sizes are combined to make up a language.

Local languages such as Urdu, Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashto, etc.

Human sounds are divided into **two broad categories**: consonants and vowels.

A consonant is a speech sound in which air is at least partly blocked.

Vowel is a sound in which there is no obstruction found and the air passes through the cavity freely.

A consonant is classified in terms of the places and manners of articulation and voicing.

A vowel is classified in terms of the position of tongue, the part of tongue and lip-rounding. Vowels are further classified in terms of pure vowels (monophthongs) and diphthongs.

There are **44 sounds in English RP** (BBC) accent. Out of them, **20 are vowels**.

Pure vowels or monophthongs **are 12** out of **which 5 are long** and **7 are short vowels**.

English diphthongs are divided into **two categories**: **centering** (which end with ‘ə’ sound) and **closing** (which end with either ‘ɪ’ or ‘ʊ’ sounds respectively).

Phonology is the study of the sounds of a particular language.

Phonetics is the study of human speech sounds. In phonetics, **the physical properties** (such as the wave form of each sound) can also be analyzed with the help of computer programs (e.g., Praat).

There are **three major types** of phonetics: **articulatory phonetics, acoustics phonetics and auditory phonetics**.

The key words for describing phonology are **‘distribution’ and ‘patterning’** related to speech.

Phonetics is the study of **actual process** of sound making.

Phonetics has been derived from the **Greek word ‘phone’ meaning sound or voice**.

Phonemes have the ability to **change meaning**.

A phoneme is the smallest meaningful **unit of sound**.

If phoneme is a group then **allophones are the group members**.

An allophone is a definable systematic variant of a phoneme.

Phonetics is the **scientific study** of speech sounds.

Articulatory phonetics deals with studying the making of **single sounds** by the vocal tract. It is the branch of phonetics which studies the way in which speech sounds are made ('articulated') by the vocal organs.

Acoustic phonetics is related to the study of **physical attributes** of sounds produced by the vocal tract.

Auditory phonetics deals with understanding how human ear perceives sound and how the brain recognizes different speech units.

Experimental phonetics is **quantitative** (based on numerical measurement).

The Sound Pattern of English by **Chomsky and Halle, 1968**.

The process of speech production mainly includes **respiration, phonation, articulation and resonance**.

The possibility of the airstream going out through the mouth, as in [v] or [z], or the nose, as in [m] and [n], is determined by the **oro-nasal process**.

Bilabial: This sound is made with two lips (for example, /p/ and /b/). The lips come together for these sounds.

Labiodentals: This sound is made when the lower lip is raised to touch the upper front teeth (for example, /f/ and /v/).

Dental: This sound is made with the tongue tip or blade and upper front teeth. For example, say the words thigh, thy and you will find the first sound in each of these words to be dental.

Alveolar: This sound is made with the tongue tip or blade and the alveolar ridge. You may pronounce words such as tie, die, nigh, sigh, zeal, lie using the tip of the tongue or the blade of the tongue for the first sound in each of these words (which are alveolar sounds).

In some languages (such as English) aspiration **is allophonic** while in others (such as Urdu) it is **phonemic**.

